

Jordan Hornblow

Te Waipounamu, Aotearoa | New Zealand

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Principal Engineer at Contented with 15+ years of experience building and scaling platforms across fintech, hospitality, legal tech, and applied AI (Xero, me&u, LawVu, Contented).

My work spans product engineering, architecture, platform reliability, and applied AI. The role sits between hands-on delivery and technical direction: scaling product architecture, strengthening AI workflows, improving reliability, and helping teams build systems that stay simple to operate as a company grows.

I care about practical engineering for real customer environments: clear architecture, secure workflows, tenant-aware systems, and AI that earns its place in the product rather than adding unnecessary complexity.

Skills

Domain Expertise: API Design, Microservices, SaaS Scaling, Automation

Core Technologies: TypeScript, Node.js, React, Python, AWS, NestJS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Azure, Terraform, Docker

AI/ML: Claude, OpenAI ChatGPT, Azure AI, Prompt Engineering

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven, API Design (REST/GraphQL)

Experience

Principal Engineer

Contented · Christchurch, New Zealand · Jun 2026 – Present

- Working across product engineering, architecture, platform reliability, and applied AI.
- Scaling the product architecture, strengthening AI workflows, and improving reliability as the company grows.
- Focused on practical engineering for real customer environments: clear architecture, secure workflows, and tenant-aware systems.
- Bridging hands-on delivery and technical direction; helping the team build systems that stay simple to operate at scale.

Senior Software Engineer L2

LawVu · Remote, New Zealand · Apr 2024 – Aug 2025

- Built contract management workflows. Improved customer onboarding speed.
- Built C# backend for approval workflows. Led migration from legacy systems.
- Built a Python/OpenAI spreadsheet transformation service to automate onboarding data prep.
- Built a PDF parsing pipeline (Python + Azure AI) that processed 10k+ legacy contracts. Beat commercial tools like Zuva on accuracy and speed.

Career Break

Austin, TX · Mar 2023 – Apr 2024

Took time away from full-time engineering to focus on health. Used this period to reset and prepare for relocation back to NZ.

Head of Integration Engineering (Principal Engineer)

me&u (FKA Mr Yum) · Melbourne / Austin, TX · Apr 2020 – Mar 2023

- Early engineer. Built and scaled third-party API integrations from 5 to 50+ partners in 18 months.
- Led integrations team of 6. Mentored 3 to promotions. Set development practices adopted across the org.
- Relocated to Austin, TX to lead US partner integrations and expand into North America.
- Broke the me&u monolith into focused services.
- Stack: TypeScript, React, NestJS, GraphQL, Terraform, AWS.
- Part of Australia's third-largest Series A (\$65M USD, 2021).

Senior Full Stack Developer

APositive · Melbourne, Australia · Dec 2016 – Jul 2020

- Built and maintained fintech products with React, Node.js, Terraform, and AWS.
- Designed and shipped APay, a workforce finance product (think Afterpay for recruiters).
- Wrote all infrastructure automation and handled cloud migration.

Developer / Senior Developer

Xero · Melbourne, Australia · May 2014 – Dec 2016

- Shipped features across multiple teams: fixed assets, quotes, 2FA, provisioning.
- Core developer on Xero TaxTouch (iOS). Covered design, development, release, and prod support.
- Worked with teams across time zones. Full end-to-end mobile delivery.
- Promoted to senior developer, Oct 2016.

Software Engineer

Telogis / Verizon Connect · Christchurch, NZ · Mar 2012 – Mar 2014

- Built backend services for Telogis Fleet SaaS with .NET, JavaScript, and PostgreSQL.
- Rebuilt the Fleet UI in Ext JS. Created reusable components picked up by other products.
- Developer exchange in Austin, TX (2013). Worked on parsing raw UDP GPS/diagnostic packets into standardized formats.

Early Career Highlights

Founder / Software Engineer, Kiwi Development (2011–2014) — Founded Kiwi Development. Accepted into Microsoft BizSpark. Delivered client projects in .NET, Ruby on Rails, and JavaScript. Managed Windows/SQL Server infrastructure. Maintained Inzone Experience kiosks across NZ.

Tutor, University of Canterbury (2011) — Taught Python & CS fundamentals. Led classes of 50. Supported Pacific students via PASS programme.

Research Intern, HITLab NZ (2010–2011) — Summer Scholarship recipient. Researched mobile AR for navigation. Ran experiments. Learned Android/AR systems.

Education

BSc (Computer Science)

University of Canterbury · Christchurch, NZ · 2009–2011

- Completed projects in Java, C, C++, Python, and Android.
- Covered the full development lifecycle: requirements, design, implementation, testing.

Achievements & Awards

- University of Canterbury Summer Scholarship (2010–2011)
- Golden Key International Honour Society (2009–present)
- College of Engineering Computer Science Scholarship (2009)
- NCEA Levels 1–3 & NZ University Entrance

Personal

Avid vinyl collector (800+ records), musician/producer aspiring to merge music + software, open-source contributor, photographer, and advocate for suicide awareness after losing two close friends.

References

References available on request.